

processes. We have a division in our company called Future Technologies, which rolls out innovative solutions which can be tested in India particularly, and then may be scaled to the rest of the portfolio across other markets.

Q Hints on future Sennheiser products and tech?

A Well, one technology that is coming out in 2024 is our new multi-channel wireless system based on wideband technology. For the first time, we won't have single carrier transmission, but really wide band transmission in time division multiplexing, using different frequencies and different time slots, which makes it extremely robust and extremely simple to operate. With that product, you would have the simplicity of switching on a cell phone combined with the perfection of audio from Sennheiser.

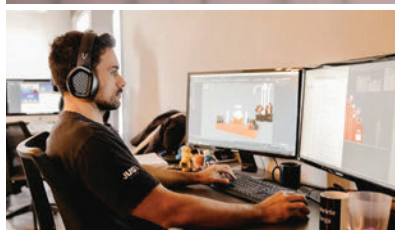
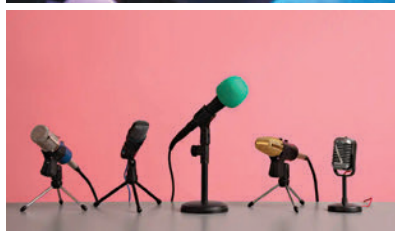
Q Is the Indian audio market still price sensitive?

A It is developing into a direction where value for money is still appreciated, but the value is much more put into how well it actually serves the purpose of the application. So it's not about the lowest price anymore, but it's really about the highest value for what you're getting. So a good example is our ceiling microphone solutions and also the classroom, the handheld solution – speech line digital. They're being appreciated very much because they just work.

For example, if you have a university with 200-400 classrooms, you don't want to save 10% on the product and then have a myriad of technicians that run around to fix it, but you'd rather spend a little bit more on the product and then operate it from a central location. And this is now really being appreciated also by the Indian market. So it's about the value of the solution and not necessarily the lowest possible price.

Q Similarities and differences between Sennheiser India vs rest of world?

A It is very similar to other markets with the exception that of course it needs



to cover quite a fragmented market in some areas, particularly in the rental business. It's still highly fragmented and therefore we have just more feet on the ground here than we would have in other countries. So we have more than 50 people in India working for us with very high technical skills, particularly because that's the value that we can provide to the Indian market.

So every salesperson that is not just somebody who can close deals, but actually is somebody who can help the customer select the right product, be technically skilled enough to even fix problems. So that's why our approach to India may be a little bit wider in terms of staff base and a little bit deeper when it comes to technology just because we have to cover such a large market that is still quite fragmented.

Q How is AI impacting the audio world?

A AI is an exciting thing because it allows us to make our microphones particularly smarter. So we will come out with microphones that will know what they're listening to and can be selective, what they want to listen to – is it speech? Is it background noise? Is it feedback?

That's how we can make our products smarter. It's not just an input device that captures audio into another system, but it becomes an input device that is much smarter than it was before.

And then of course, on the processing side we are using AI now in test labs in order to make different audio signals sound very much the same. That's very important when you have conferences and somebody sitting in a room with a lot of reverb, another one sitting in a studio like room, and if you have these different audio coming in, it's very stressful for the brain. So it helps to reduce fatigue if we can normalise these different audio streams and just make it more, more nice to listen to.

Q Future of audio entertainment?

A We see more and more people enjoying live concerts again. I think it's a human need for us all to enjoy music together, because that has a uniting element for everyone. And so that's definitely one of the high growth vectors right now. The other thing that we see coming more and more is that these events are no longer just happening in one place, but actually are being teleported to other locations.

The term metaverse may be overused, but what I like to use it for is that actually we can teleport an experience that happens in Madison Square Garden, for instance, using AR and XR technology combined, we can actually teleport that into someone's living room and or someone's VR goggles. I guess this part will become more and more interesting also for artists because they reach not just the 50,000 people in the venue, but they can reach hundreds of millions of people around the world with almost the same experience. **d**

